Grade 12 Business Studies

Paper 2

Business Ventures and Business Roles
150 marks · 2 hours · Randomized subject seed 20261101
Answer Section A, any TWO questions in Section B, and any ONE question in Section C.

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Instructions

1. Write your name and class on every answer sheet.
2. Answer all of Section A.
3. In Section B, answer any TWO questions. Each question is 40 marks; only the first two answers will be marked.
4. In Section C, answer any ONE essay question.
5. Number answers exactly as in the paper. Show calculations where relevant.

Contents: Section A 30 marks; Section B 80 marks counted; Section C 40 marks. Total 150.

SECTION A · COMPULSORY (30 marks)

Choose the best answer. Each item is worth 2 marks.

1. Which environment is most directly shaped by a new municipal by-law?
    A. Market
    B. Macro
    C. Micro
    D. Internal
2. A business's internal strength is best described as:
    A. a controllable capability
    B. a new tax
    C. a competitor action
    D. a customer trend
3. Which action is a corrective control?

A. Set a standard
B. Measure output
C. Compare result with standard
D. Fix a recorded variance

4. A supplier’s reliability is primarily relevant to:
    A. procurement
    B. branding
    C. ownership
    D. market segmentation
5. The purpose of induction is to:
    A. orient a new employee
    B. audit annual accounts
    C. forecast sales
    D. register a trademark
6. A stakeholder consultation should happen:
    A. after all decisions are irreversible
    B. early enough to inform the decision
    C. only if no law applies
    D. only with customers
7. The Consumer Protection Act chiefly strengthens:
    A. consumer rights
    B. supplier ownership
    C. company tax status
    D. staff seniority
8. A quality standard should be:
    A. observable and measurable
    B. secret
    C. changed each shift
    D. based only on opinion
9. A co-operative is generally owned by:
    A. its members
    B. one external lender
    C. the municipality
    D. its largest customer
10. Break-even occurs when:
    A. total revenue equals total cost
    B. profit is at its maximum
    C. fixed cost is zero
    D. sales are zero
11. A business plan should include:
    A. market and operating assumptions
    B. only a logo

C. only a loan request
D. unverified testimonials

12.Using a rival’s photos without permission may breach:
A. intellectual-property rights
B. stock rotation
C. job evaluation
D. cash budgeting

13.Market research is used to:
A. inform decisions about customers
B. guarantee success
C. remove all uncertainty
D. replace accounting records

14.A conflict of interest arises when:
A. private interests may bias a duty
B. a budget is approved
C. a target is met
D. a customer returns a product

15.A sustainability decision considers:
A. economic, social and environmental effects
B. sales only
C. publicity only
D. short-term cost only

SECTION B · ANSWER ANY TWO (80 marks counted)

Each question is worth 40 marks. Use relevant business terminology and apply your answers to the information provided.

Question 1: Case study — Imbali Solar Co-operative (40 marks)

Read the case study and answer all parts.
Imbali Solar Co-operative makes solar lanterns and employs 18 people. Three members want to convert the co-operative into a private company to attract investment. The team has a prototype but has not tested willingness to pay. A supplier offers credit if the business provides security. One founder proposes using a competitor’s product photographs in a crowdfunding campaign. The co-operative has received customer complaints about battery life and is preparing a three-year growth plan.

1.1 Identify two risks in the proposed crowdfunding campaign. (4) [4]

1.2 Explain two differences between a co-operative and a private company that matter to Imbali. (8) [8]

1.3 Recommend two low-cost ways to test customer demand before scaling. (8) [8]

1.4 Discuss how Imbali should respond to the battery-life complaints. (8) [8]

1.5 Advise the members on whether to accept supplier credit, using cash-flow and security considerations. (12) [12]

Question 2: Applied business ventures (40 marks)

2.1 Name four elements commonly included in a business plan. (4) [4]

2.2 Explain how a break-even analysis supports a start-up decision. (8) [8]

2.3 Discuss four sources of finance suitable for different stages of a small enterprise. (8) [8]

2.4 A founder must choose between a sole proprietorship and a private company. Analyse relevant liability, control and continuity trade-offs. (10) [10]

2.5 Evaluate the role of market research in reducing uncertainty, including two limits. (10) [10]

Question 3: Applied business roles (40 marks)

3.1 State four ethical principles that can guide business decisions. (4) [4]

3.2 Explain how corporate social responsibility differs from a once-off donation. (8) [8]

3.3 Discuss four actions managers can take to support diversity and fair treatment. (8) [8]

3.4 Analyse how conflict of interest can damage stakeholder trust and propose controls. (10) [10]

3.5 Recommend a balanced approach to sustainability that considers economic, social and environmental outcomes. (10) [10]

SECTION C · ANSWER ANY ONE (40 marks)

Write a structured essay with an introduction, developed discussion, application or examples, and conclusion. Each essay is assessed against the same rubric: introduction and framing (4); accurate knowledge and explanation (12); analysis and application to the stated topic (12); evaluation, justified recommendation or synthesis (8); coherent conclusion and structure (4).

Essay option 1 · Business Ventures (40 marks)

Analyse and evaluate how a South African business can respond effectively to current challenges in business ventures. Develop a balanced argument, use relevant examples and finish with a justified conclusion.

Essay option 2 · Business Roles (40 marks)

Discuss and recommend how a South African business can respond effectively to current challenges in business roles. Develop a balanced argument, use relevant examples and finish with a justified conclusion.

End of Paper 2. Check that you have answered the required number of questions.